IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE E

Measure E is a bond measure placed on the ballot by the Ferndale Unified School District, which would allow the district to issue bonds in the amount of up to $7 million to pay for specific school facilities projects. Measure E must be approved by a 55 percent vote.

The California Constitution authorizes a school district to issue bonds for "the construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, including the furnishing and equipping of school facilities, or the acquisition or lease of real property for school facilities." The use of the funds is restricted to these uses, and "not for any other purpose, including teacher and administrator salaries and other school operating expenses." The measure must include "a list of specific school facilities projects to be funded by the bond." Measure E complies with this requirement, listing projects related to creating and upgrading facilities for career technical education.

By law, the district must "conduct an annual, independent performance audit to ensure that the funds have been expended only on the specific projects listed." This audit is then provided to a citizen's oversight committee, whose purpose is to inform and advise the public on the expenditure of bond funds. Measure E complies with these requirements as well.

California's Proposition 13 generally prohibits the imposition of an ad valorem property tax exceeding one percent. (An ad valorem tax is a tax on real property as a percentage of the cash value of the property.) However, there is an exception that allows a school district to levy an ad valorem tax which exceeds this one percent for the limited purpose of construction related to school facilities. The maximum tax allowed by law for a unified school district is $60 per $100,000 of assessed property value. As stated in the ballot question and the tax rate statement included with the ballot materials, the district estimates that the average tax levy necessary to pay for the debt obligation would be $49.70 per $100,000 of assessed property value.

The bonds would allow the district to raise $7 million. The district estimates that total debt service, including principal and interest, required to be paid if all bonds are issued and sold, would be $15.4 million.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure E. If you desire a copy of the ordinance or measure, please call the elections official's office at 707-445-7481 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

You may also access the full text of the measure on the county website at the following website address (www.humboldtgov.org/elections).

Argument in Favor of Measure E

Our schools are amongst this community's most important assets, and our Career Technical Education and Agricultural programs are a large part of that. With high-quality schools and programs come improved student achievement, better preparation for their futures, informative decision-making skills and strengthened neighborhood safety, all of which raise our community and property values. Ferndale's teachers and staff do excellent work, but many facilities in the Ferndale Unified School District utilize outdated equipment, classrooms and labs that are no longer able to meet students' needs.

Measure E allows Ferndale to secure millions in state funding for CTE programs. The District already received a $3 million State CTE grant for a new Agriculture Education building, and voter approval of Measure E could unlock another $3 million grant to replace the aging shop building. Without Measure E, Ferndale would not have the required local matching dollars to receive these and other grants, sending millions in education dollars to another community.

Measure E prepares Ferndale students for careers and college by:
- Constructing and modernizing CTE classrooms, labs, and related facilities, including a new Agriculture Education building
- Making health, safety, security, and ADA improvements for CTE facilities and programs
- Upgrading CTE-related kitchens, training facilities, and outdoor spaces

Measure E makes financial sense and protects taxpayers by:
- Requiring annual audits by an independent citizens' oversight committee
- Funds can only be spent on CTE-related facilities, not administrator or teacher salaries
- All bond funds must be spent locally and cannot be taken by the State

Ferndale Elementary is a Distinguished School, and Ferndale High has an award-winning FFA program. Measure E builds on this success by providing facilities that match the quality of our CTE and Agriculture programs and give students hands-on, career-ready training for college and the workforce.

Don't let $6 million go to another community. **VOTE YES ON MEASURE E!**

/s/ William G. Becker, Retired Business Owner
/s/ Jim Walker, Dairyman
/s/ Alexa Alexandre, Agriculture Teacher
/s/ Luke McCanless, Dairyman
/s/ Bruce Titus, Business Owner